Mission Briefing: Mission 6 – Excavation Site

Resonance Cascade: The Dig on Xolkan

The crystal found in the caves of Ontranis did not remain silent after it was claimed. Contact with a living mind, and the moment it was carried off-world, sent a psychic shock through the remaining shards. Across the Loppian System the cascade answered. Every sensor, every scavenged detector, every fractured psy-array lit with the same screaming signature. At the same time the Voidsun itself began to stir. The second Voidcrown fragment had revealed itself — buried deep in the wreckage fields of Xolkan.

Once the culmination of the Frog-Mages' psychic ambitions, the Voidsun lies at the heart of the system: a second sun of pure psychic fire, born when the ancient storms were forced into a single raging heart. The three crystals are the keys that once channelled its power. Since the first shard left Ontranis the black sun has grown restless. Storms have thickened across the outer worlds. Reality frays a little further each day. The pressure is no longer subtle, and every warband with eyes to see can feel the change.

Xolkan was never a gentle world. Long ago it served as a mining colony under the Frog-Mages' Truth, its surface scarred by open pits and half-buried machinery. Now the outer world is a graveyard of shattered hulls, collapsed temples, and abandoned dig sites. The cascade has drawn every ambitious warband to the same coordinates, where the second crystal lies buried beneath layers of wreckage and frozen earth. Some come seeking the power the shards promise. Others come only to deny that power to their rivals. All of them must dig.

The dig site itself is treacherous ground. Broken decks and ancient stone form a maze of unstable trenches, collapsing platforms, and half-excavated chambers. The psychic cascade rattles the air. Heavy machinery lies half-buried in the ice, its silence broken only by the occasional groan of shifting wreckage. The longer the battle rages, the more the ground seems to settle and shift as if the world itself is listening to the resonance.

Warbands must push into the heart of the excavation, seize the key sites that mark the crystal's resting place, and hold them long enough to extract the prize. There will be no clean extraction. Only the force that dominates the dig and still has strength left to carry the shard away will leave Xolkan richer than they arrived.

The Voidsun is stirring. The storms are already howling.

MISSION 6 – EXCAVATION SITE

MISSION BACKGROUND

Xolkan is littered with valuable equipment fallen from the wreckage fields above its skies; Jackals had long visited the world to collect salvage. Many of those who came seeking the Voidcrown crystal hidden there instead found themselves added to the pile of debris.

THE BATTLEFIELD

For this mission you'll need a 6'x4' area, with 15+ pieces of terrain.

THE ARMIES

For this mission you'll need two armies of equal point cost.

DEPLOYMENT

The players roll-off, and the winner picks zone A or B to be their deployment zone, with their opponent taking the opposite. Then the players alternate in placing one unit each within their deployment zone, starting with the player that won the deployment roll-off.

FIRST TURN

The player that has won the deployment roll-off gets the first turn.

OBJECTIVES

Before deployment, players have to set up a total of D3+3 objective markers.

The players roll-off to see who goes first, and then alternate in placing one objective marker each outside of the deployment zones, and at least 9" away from other objectives.

At the end of each round, if a unit is within 3" of a marker whilst enemies aren't, then the objective is seized.

Markers stay under the player's control even after leaving, but if units from both sides are contesting a marker then it becomes neutral again.

At the end of the game players get 1 VP for each objective they fully excavated, plus 1 VP if they fully excavated more objective markers than their opponent.

Players also get 1 VP if at least one of their non-shaken units is in the enemy deployment zone, as well as 1 VP if they destroyed at least three enemy units.

The game ends after 5 rounds, and the player that scored most VPs wins.

SPECIAL RULES

Excavation: At the end of each round, starting with the player that finished activating first, players alternate in excavating one of the objectives they control which has a friendly unit within 3". Place one excavation token on the objective, and roll a D3+X, where X is the number of tokens on it. On a 4+, the objective is fully excavated, and the marker is removed from the table. Then roll one die, and apply the effect to one random friendly unit within 3" of that objective:

Result	Event
1-2	**Hidden Bomb –** The unit takes D6 hits with AP(2).
3-4	**Teleporter –** The unit may be placed anywhere on the table, over 9" away from enemy units.
5-6	**Ammo Cache –** The unit may immediately shoot.

SPECIAL EQUIPMENT

Mining Drill: Before the game begins, each army may provide one unit with a mining drill. If a unit with a drill is within 3" of an objective marker at the end of the round, you may add one excavation token on it.

Wave Locator: Before the game begins, each army may provide one unit with a wave locator. Once per game, if a unit with a locator is within 3" of an objective marker when it is fully excavated, you may re-roll on the excavation table.

